

First day, 120 minutes

READ THIS BEFORE THE RUN ORDER

Mingle before solo, and the Ladder last. A diagnostic in the first half hour sets a test tone on day one and tells them this year is about marks. Put the speaking first, the Ladder in the quiet middle-to-late stretch, and open the book before they leave so the year starts with the book, not with a score.

The risk with this group is not shyness. Five students who may already know each other will settle into Spanish and into a pecking order within twenty minutes if you let them. The defence is the language box on page 2, taught before the mingle and enforced during it, and the rule that they must collect a name from every person in the room, not just the friend next to them.

The six lines on page 3 are a B2 writing sample, not an icebreaker. Each frame carries a structure the book will test: a relative clause, a non-defining relative, present perfect continuous, present continuous against present simple, and a second conditional. Collect the booklet at the end. What they can and cannot finish there is worth more than the Ladder score.

Run order

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT YOU DO
15:45 3 min	Open	Names on the board, yours included. Four rules, said once, in English, not negotiated: we speak English in this room, we answer in full sentences, phones in bags, everybody talks. Do not ask if they agree.
15:48 7 min	Tell me a bit about you page 1	Silent, seated, individual. Twelve questions, a few words each. Tell them they will be asking these same questions round the room in a minute, so the answers should be true rather than clever. Help with vocabulary only.
15:55 15 min	Now find your people page 2	Everybody stands, chairs pushed back. Teach the page 2 box first, <i>So do I, Neither do I, I'm not sure I agree, It depends what you mean by</i> , and make them say each one aloud once before they start. Rule: one name from every person in the room, and every answer written down must have had a follow-up question attached to it. Circulate, do not correct, note who reverts to Spanish. Stop it while it is still noisy.
16:10 10 min	Build six lines page 3	They turn their page 1 answers into the six frames. Do not help with the structures, that is the diagnosis. Line 6 names the classmate they matched with.
16:20 5 min	Rehearse in pairs page 3	Each says all six lines to one partner, partner gives one piece of advice, then swap. Nobody presents without having said it out loud once.
16:25 16 min	Stand and deliver page 3	All five, standing, at the front. Ninety seconds each. They may hold the paper but not read it word for word. Listeners complete the page 3 grid and ask two questions each from the floor, and "why?" is banned. You go first, and model a B2 answer, not a simple one. If someone dries up: ask one of three prepared questions instead of waiting. Whereabouts in Valencia exactly? What made you choose that? How long have you been doing it? Never let the silence run.
16:41 9 min	Common ground page 4	Whole class, standing or in a circle. Three things true of all six of you, including you, each written as a full sentence starting <i>All of us, None of us or Every one of us</i> . Reject the obvious ones out loud. The three go on the board and stay there. Then each writes their Task 7 sentence.
16:50 5 min	Break	Short, and say when you want them back. This is the point in a two-hour Friday where the class either restarts or drifts.
16:55 32 min	Level Ladder pages 5 to 7	Same booklet, no second handout. Seated, silent, individual. One sentence of explanation: not an exam, covers the whole year, guessing is fine. The 80-word message on page 7 is a fast-finisher only. If you are behind , stop at Part 4 and finish it next Friday. Never cut the stand-up or the rehearsal to save it.
17:27 15 min	Open the book	New Close-up B2 Split A, Unit 1 <i>Jump for joy</i> , Student's Book pages 5 to 7. The opening photo and the first discussion questions only. Teacher's notes at PDF page 20 of <i>Close_up_B2_Teachers_Book.md</i> . The point is that the book is open on day one.
17:42 3 min	Close	They write their December goal on page 4. Collect the whole booklet and hand it back in December. Tell them what Tuesday and Thursday are for compared with Friday.

Who is confident, and who is not

HOW TO USE THIS

Fill it in during the stand-up, not afterwards. You are recording behaviour, not marking English. At B2 the useful distinction is not fluent against hesitant, it is **reaching against playing safe**: a student who attempts a relative clause and mangles it is a better bet for June than one who delivers six flawless simple sentences. Quiet and unwilling need opposite treatment, so keep them apart in your notes.

During the presentations

STUDENT	MARTA	ELENA	AINHOA	VALERIA	SONIA
How long she spoke					
Read every word, or looked up?					
Voice reached the back?					
Reached for a structure, or played safe?					
Which of the six frames defeated her?					
Answered a question from the floor					
Asked someone a real question					
Needed prompting					
Quiet, or unwilling?					

During the mingle, which is where the truth usually is

STUDENT	MARTA	ELENA	AINHOA	VALERIA	SONIA
Started, or waited?					
Used the page 2 language					
Asked follow-ups unprompted					
Switched to Spanish when stuck					
Gravitated towards?					

Decide before you leave the room

Strongest speaker, and who to pair her with so she does not become the class translator?	
Who spoke least, and the smallest thing she will definitely manage next Friday?	
Which two found something in common, and can that pairing carry into Unit 1?	
Who defaulted to Spanish first, and what will you do about it in week two?	

Line 6 is the one that builds the class. Every presentation ends by naming another student, so five presentations means five public connections. Do not let anyone skip it, including the pair who already know each other.

Feeds into Unit 1. Page 1 question 3 is present simple habit, question 4 is present continuous, question 12 is personality adjectives, and page 3 line 4 is the simple against continuous contrast. That is the Unit 1 *Jump for joy* syllabus, produced by them in their own words before they open the book.

The Level Ladder, key and diagnosis

WHAT THIS IS MEASURING

Six parts, one per unit of New Close-up B2 Split A. The class has not studied any of it yet, so a low total is expected and is not the point. Each part is four grammar items and two vocabulary items from the unit's own topic set. The grammar scores tell you what you can move through quickly. The vocabulary scores are a rough signal only, since the book's glossary is new to them. Several items are deliberate B2 discriminators rather than B1 revision: 9 and 10 separate *used to* from *be used to*, 14 and 15 separate past perfect simple from continuous, 27 is a perfect modal, and 32 turns on *stop* plus infinitive of purpose. Those four are the ones worth looking at first.

Answer key, 36 marks

	ANS	UNIT	WHAT IT TESTS		ANS	UNIT	WHAT IT TESTS
1	is worrying	1	present continuous, temporary	19	will be living	4	future continuous
2	tastes	1	stative verb, not continuous	20	will have been finished	4	future perfect passive
3	think	1	think as opinion, stative	21	are going to drop	4	going to, present evidence
4	are getting	1	continuous, changing situation	22	leaves	4	present simple, timetable
5	embarrassed	1	emotions, -ed against -ing	23	outskirts	4	cities
6	stubborn	1	personality adjectives	24	bustling	4	describing districts
7	was passing	2	past continuous, interrupted	25	mustn't	5	prohibition, not absence of obligation
8	would	2	would, repeated past action	26	might	5	modals of probability
9	used to	2	used to with a stative verb	27	should	5	perfect modal, criticism
10	am used to	2	be used to plus noun	28	can't	5	deduction, impossibility
11	ritual	2	traditions	29	backup	5	compound noun
12	parade	2	festivals	30	attachments	5	technology
13	had already started	3	past perfect, earlier past	31	waiting	6	verb plus -ing
14	had been running	3	past perfect continuous, duration	32	to tie	6	stop plus infinitive of purpose
15	had cut	3	past perfect simple, result	33	taking	6	preposition plus -ing
16	had lost	3	past perfect before a past point	34	to get	6	verb plus infinitive
17	determination	3	success nouns	35	course	6	sports venues
18	inspire	3	fame and influence verbs	36	laps	6	sports nouns

Marking the extra message. Do not mark it out of anything. Read it for three things only: does she control tenses beyond the present, does she link ideas with anything more than *and* and *but*, and is the register appropriate to a note to a teacher. Those three are the whole FCE Writing diagnosis at this stage.

Who knows what

Marks by unit, 6 per unit

UNIT	MARTA	ELENA	AINHOA	VALERIA	SONIA
1 Jump for joy (Q1 to 6)					
2 Global culture? (Q7 to 12)					
3 Role models (Q13 to 18)					
4 City living (Q19 to 24)					
5 Emerging technologies (Q25 to 30)					
6 Take it easy (Q31 to 36)					
TOTAL / 36					
Wrote the extra message?					

The four discriminators, tick if correct

ITEM	MARTA	ELENA	AINHOA	VALERIA	SONIA
9 and 10 used to against be used to					
14 and 15 past perfect simple against continuous					
27 perfect modal					
32 stop plus infinitive					

A student who gets a high total but misses all four of these is a B1 student with good exam instincts, not a B2 student. That is the distinction this sheet exists to make.

Reading a single unit column

SCORE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR THAT UNIT	WHAT TO DO
5 or 6	The grammar is already there. The unit will be revision plus new vocabulary and the exam task.	Move fast through the grammar pages. Spend the time on Use of English and Speaking.
3 or 4	Partly there, usually the form but not the choice between two structures.	Teach normally. Add one contrast drill on the exact pair she confused.
0 to 2	New. Do not assume any of it.	Budget a full extra session. Start from meaning, not from the rule.

Reading the total

/ 36	WHERE SHE IS
30 to 36	Already operating at B2. Split A will not stretch her on grammar. Plan extension and push her towards the harder FCE papers early.
22 to 29	Solid B2 entry. The book is correctly pitched.
14 to 21	Strong B1 moving into B2, which is normal for the first Friday of an FCE year. Expect the grammar load to feel heavy until Christmas.
0 to 13	Below the book's entry point. Check first whether she was guessing at random, then plan B1 consolidation running alongside Unit 1.

After marking, answer these three

Which unit scored lowest across the whole class?	
Who is furthest ahead, and what will you give her?	
Who is furthest behind, and what is the first thing to fix?	

When this happens. 16:55 to 17:27 on the run sheet, page 1, after the speaking and the break. Do not mark it in front of them, and do not let it eat the stand-up. Mark it over the weekend, bring the results back next Friday with the plan already adjusted, and tell them nothing about their score until you have something to do with it.